

accept electronics for recycling, often regardless of where they were purchased.

- **Community E-Waste Events:** Local governments or organisations frequently host events for residents to drop off e-waste.

Data wiping before tech disposal

- **Backup Data:** Before wiping, ensure all important data is backed up.
- **Factory Reset:**
 - **Smartphones/Tablets:** Use the factory reset option in settings to erase personal data.
 - **Computers:** Use disk formatting tools or third-party software to securely erase hard drives.
- **Remove SIM and Memory Cards:** These may contain personal information and can be reused or destroyed.

Few upcycling ideas for old devices

Transforming outdated gadgets into useful tools reduces waste and can save money.

Turn old phones into security cameras

- **How-To:**
 - **Install a Security App:** Use apps like Alfred Camera or Manything to repurpose your phone as a security camera.
 - **Set Up the Device:** Place the phone where monitoring is desired, connected to Wi-Fi and a power source.
 - **Monitor Remotely:** Access live feeds and recordings from your primary device.

Use laptops as media servers

- **Convert to a Media Server:**
 - **Install Media Server Software:** Use platforms like Plex or Kodi.
 - **Store Media Files:** Centralise your movies, music, and photos.
 - **Stream to Other Devices:** Access your media library from smart TVs, tablets, or smartphones.

How to safely donate old devices

Donating can help others while keeping electronics out of landfills.

Finding local donation programs

- **Schools and Educational Programs:** Many accept devices for student use.
- **Non-Profit Organisations:** Groups like Goodwill, Habitat for Humanity or Salvation Army take electronics for resale or donation.
- **Community Centers:** Local centres may need devices for educational or administrative purposes. Refurbishment programs for charities

■ National Organisations:

- **Cell Phones for Soldiers:** Provides communication services to military members.
- **Computers with Causes:** Donates refurbished computers to those in need.

■ Preparation for Donation:

- **Data Erasure:** Ensure all personal information is removed.
- **Include Accessories:** Chargers and peripherals can be helpful to recipients.

3) Embrace digital minimalism

Digital minimalism advocates for a more intentional and mindful use of technology, focusing on what truly adds value to your life.

What is digital minimalism?

- **Philosophy:** Emphasises quality over quantity in digital engagement.
- **Goal:** Reduce digital clutter and distractions to improve mental well-being and productivity.

Benefits of reducing tech dependence

- **Enhanced Focus:** Fewer distractions lead to better concentration.
- **Improved Relationships:** More time and attention for in-person interactions.
- **Mental Health:** Reduced stress and anxiety associated with constant connectivity.

Identifying redundant apps and tools

- **Audit Your Devices:** List all installed apps and software.
- **Assess Usage:** Determine how frequently you use each app and its value.
- **Eliminate Duplicates:** Remove apps that serve the same purpose.

4) Educate others on responsible tech use

Sharing knowledge about sustainable and ethical tech practices amplifies their impact and fosters a community of responsible users.

Discussing privacy and data awareness

Promoting awareness about online privacy helps protect individuals and communities.

How to share best practices with family

- **Open Conversations:** Discuss the importance of privacy in everyday language.
- **Set Up Privacy Settings Together:** Help family members configure their devices and accounts securely.